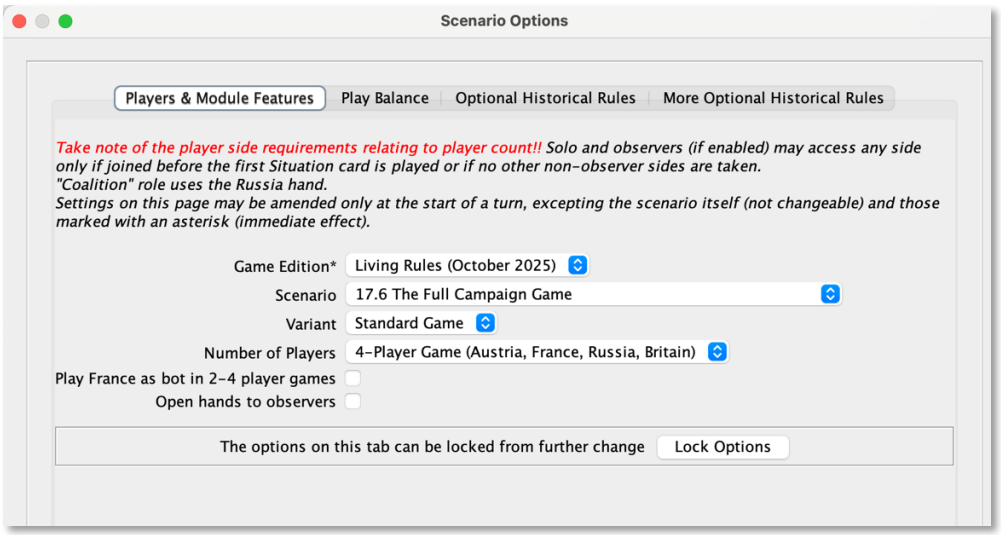
Congress of Vienna Vassal Module

Starting a new game

1. **Launch the game**. Start the game as you normally would in Vassal.
2. **Choose Your Side**
   - If you're playing a 2- or 3-player game, the player controlling multiple powers should select *Coalition*. This player will be referred to as the *Coalition* throughout the game.
   - If you're playing a solo game, choose *Solo*, to gain access to all Powers' windows.
   - Otherwise, just select your designated power.
3. **Initial Setup.** There are no scenarios to select during game start. This is selected after the game launches using the *Scenario Options* Dialog.

Scenario Options

When the game is started a scenario options dialog pane opens.



- **Players & Module Features:**
  - *Game Edition:* Used to note which rules are in effect. Two rule differences - one affecting wager in solo mode or when the French bot is in use, and another Scenario specific rule for "Clash of Armies" Future Govt of France. Players are recommended to use the latest edition, at least for new games.
  - *Scenario* is used to select which, among the six detailed in the Playbook (and a bonus scenario from the Designer, "Austria's Dilemma: Peace or War"), scenario to set up, or to get a blank map to set up by yourself or by loading a game
  - *Variant:* The "Short Turn" variant is described in this InsideGMT article: https://insidegmt.com/an-optional-variant-to-speed-play-of-congress-of-vienna/
  - *Number of players* is used to decide which type of game to play. Either 4-player, 3-player, 2-player or Solo CDG. Note that you can always play any of the game types as Solo, giving you access to all player hands.

    - *Play France as bot in 2-4 player games:* an experimental variant from the Development team. France plays from the Solo mat in this variant. Not supported officially.
    - *Open hands to Observers:* this option allows a game to be set so that observers can view all hands. Intended for demonstration and tuition games.
- **Play Balance**
    - *Initial Situation Card Play:* "Random" will have the game draw a random card, each turn, "manual" allows the players to choose the situation card for each turn and the other options for choosing a specific set of situation cards to use throughout the game
    - *Handicap Cards:* This is a set of options detailing if, and how, to use handicap cards
    - *Coalition Strength:* See Playbook, section 20.13, point 3
- **Optional Historical Rules:**
    - This tab is used to state which optional rules, such as *Landing in Holland* or The *Tactical Battle Matrix* is used in the game.
    - **Important:** for Historical Rules, explicitly selecting them is usually mandatory as the needed game pieces and setup is not performed otherwise.
- **More Optional Historical Rules:**
    - This is a list of optional rules that are published on Inside GMT and not available in the printed version. Selecting which of these rules to use is informative only, no specific alterations to the game is made.

You can always revisit the options screen by choosing File => Scenario Options in the Game menu. Note that only those options marked by an asterisk may be changed after the game starts. Due to vassal limitations you may mark them as changed but that won't have an effect.

Toolbar Buttons

Undo: This is VASSAL's standard "undo" function to take back moves.

Forward: This is VASSAL's standard "Forward" function to move through a play log.

Server Controls: This is VASSAL's standard function to show/hide server connections pane

Retire: This is VASSAL's standard "retire" function to switch between player sides or become an observer.

Player Aid: This opens a window with player aid information, including the printed player aid sheet, the rule- & playbook backsides plus plenty of additional charts and info.

Additional Markers: This opens a window with additional markers that are not available on the board, for example Additional Resources and US Military Operation.

Sequence of Play: This button opens a window with the sequence of play. In addition, this includes a ruler to mark the current position in the sequence and direct access to specific game functions related to the sequence, for example card dealing

Card Window: This opens the card window where you will find the gamecard decks such as the deck of situation cards and handicap cards

Deal menu: This button shows a menu where you can draw situation cards and deal character and handicap cards. Note that the option may be disabled based on the state of the game, for example character cards cannot be dealt if the situation card hasn't been resolved yet.

Initial Environment card draw. In the Initial environment roll a power will be selected to draw a card. Click this button to open a window used to select the cards. During other game segments this button will be grayed out.

Austrian Hand Window: This opens a window with all the Austrian cards if you play as Austria or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Austrian hand. This button is unavailable in 2- or 3-player games and in Solo CDG games.

French Hand Window: This opens a window with all the French cards if you play as France or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the French hand.

Russian Hand Window: This opens a window with all the Russian cards, or coalition cards in 2- or 3-player games and in Solo CDG games, if you play as Russia, Solo or Coalition. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Russian hand.

British Hand Window: This opens a window with all the British cards if you play as Britain or Solo. The number to the right is the number of cards in the Austrian hand. This button is unavailable in 2-player games and in Solo CDG games.

Roll 1d6: Rolls a d6 and displays the result. The color of the result indicates which power made the roll

French Battle Roll: Roll 2d6 to determine a battle result.

Coalition Battle Roll: Roll 2d6 to determine a battle result.

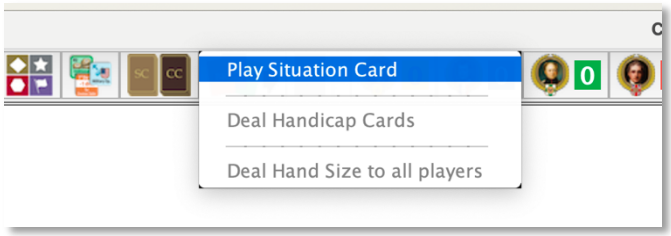
Fronts: This brings down a menu where you can choose which fronts to determine battle results. The Battle DRM track will set the pawns based on the units available in the respective armies. Only fronts with Military Operation markers are available. The circled letter to the right shows the currently selected front.

Current Round/Power: This is not an actual button, it's an information marker that tells the current negotiation round (the digit) and the active power (the color)

End Round: Ends the active side's round during the Diplomacy Round Sequence

Reset: This button resolves end of turn VP awards and resets the game in preparation of a new turn

Initial phase: Draw and resolve a Situation Card



1. Click the *Deal cards* menu button in the toolbar
2. Select *Play Situation Card*
3. The card will appear to the right of the Pax Britannica track and will also be written out in the chat box window. All instructions will be automatically resolved by the module except for deferred actions and actions requiring an active decision.

TIP: The module is quite verbose about its activities. Check the chat box if you're unsure about which instructions were resolved.

Initial phase: Make the environmental table roll

Click the Roll 1d6 button twice. The effect listed in the charts, and the number of US militia, will be resolved automatically by the module.

Initial phase: Deal a card to the power chosen by the Environment table roll

1. The button that opens a window used to select a card should now be available with text and color indicating the power that can select a card.
2. The selected power clicks the button to open the window. On the left there is a deck containing all available cards for the chosen power.
3. Right-click the deck and select *Select a Card to Draw*
4. A smaller window opens listing all cards by power, strength and military capability.
5. Select the card and click *Ok*
6. The player draws the card to the space marked *Drop Card here* which will transfer it to the player's hand.

Diplomacy phase: Deal Character Cards

Use the *Deal* button in the toolbar to deal cards. The number of cards dealt to each player is based on the markers on the *Card Hand Size Track* on the board, as well as on scenario specific rules.

IMPORTANT: Card dealing is time consuming, please be patient. The module will comment its progress in the chat window

Character cards and card windows

Character cards are organized in three rows and when cards are dealt to the powers they will be semi sorted in these rows. The top row will contain the cards corresponding to the power. The middle and bottom rows will contain

- For **France**: Austrian and British cards in the middle, Russian and neutral in the bottom
- For **Coalition powers**: The other coalition power's cards in the middle, French and neutral in the bottom
- In **2 or 3-player** games the Coalition player will have Austrian and Russian cards in the top row, British and Neutral card in the middle and French cards in the bottom row.

French hand after receiving 15 cards

The cards can be freely moved around, and stacked, in the window.

The same hand as before but after player sorting. Row 1 & 2 contains cards usable for negotiations and debates, the 3rd row has one stack of cards that can be traded, one stack of cards to use as military cards, and to the far right is the card selected for Wager

Diplomacy phase: Wager

1. Right-click the card and select "Wager as *Power*", where *Power* corresponds to the player's power.
2. The card will be placed, face-down, on the negotiation table, on the selected power's diplomacy track.
3. When all powers have selected their wager card they can be flipped using the corresponding context menu option. Additionally, all wager cards may be revealed simultaneous by using the context menu found on the big golden pawn

TIP: The wager can also be performed "manually" by dragging it to the table.

Resolving Ties

If the wager ends in a tie, the British player should right click the big golden pawn used to mark player turn orders. The context menu allows the player to select a winner.

Russian *Imperial Staff* Special Ability

If the conditions for Russia's special wager ability are true then Russia has the ability to change their wager card. To do so they just open their hand window and select a new card to wager. If they do not wish to play a new card, however, they right-click the big golden pawn and select "Finalize Wager".

Diplomacy phase: Issue Selection

In order, players can then select the issues and drag them (or use the issue's context menu) to the negotiation table. For the wager winner the context menu option (on an issue marker) "Claim Wager Win" will add the issue to the wager winner's track and clear the board of wager cards (but it can also be dragged manually).

Diplomacy phase: Negotiations and round-markers

The easiest way to start the diplomacy phase is to use the "Next Round" button. Alternatively, the round marker for the power can be pushed forward. Use the same way to complete a round and leave play for the next power (i.e. use the "Next Round" button or move a round marker).

IMPORTANT: You **MUST** use one of these two methods for the next player to be able to play.

Diplomacy phase: Playing a card for negotiation or debate

1. Right-click a card in your hand and select *Play*
2. The card will be placed, face up, on the negotiation table.

TIP: You may also just drag a card to the table.

Diplomacy phase: Leader Cards

Leader cards appear in the top-left part of the hand. They cannot be played, and they do not count towards the hand size. In addition, they can be found as mini cards right by the end of the power's respective diplomacy track. Don't worry about the small size, hovering the mouse over a leader card will have a larger version pop-up. In addition, images of all leader cards can be found in the player aid.

To play a Leader you must discard another card. Right-click the card chosen for discard and select *Play for *Leader**, where *Leader* is the name of the player's leader (e.g. Napoleon). The leader and the discarded card will end up on the diplomacy table. After leader play is finished, select *Flip (Leader Used)*. This will bring the leader card back to the hand but with its backside up, indicating that it has been played. The mini card on the Diplomacy board will also have its backside up.

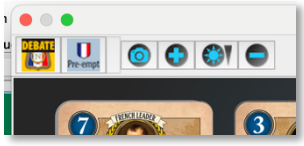
Diplomacy phase: Trading

Trading is only available to the active power, determined by the round-marker positions. As in the physical game they are treated as an agreement between the players. When a deal is concluded, and both players agree to do the trade,

1. The active player right-clicks the card chosen to trade and selects the menu option *Trade with *Power**, where *Power* corresponds to the other power in the negotiation.
2. Note that it is not possible to "Trade with…" any other power than the power corresponding to the card (which means that neutral cards doesn't have the "Trade with…" option)
3. Now, the power the active player has chosen to trade with, have the "Trade with…" card options enabled for cards belonging to the active player. When the menu option is chosen, the cards are traded and moved to the "Trade" area of each player's hand. If the chosen player wants to decline the trade use the decline button in the card window

Diplomacy phase: Debating

On each player hand window is a toolbar button used for debating. Whenever a player has the option to debate, they can click this button (it will write a message in the chat window). France has two such buttons, one to use during ordinary French debates, and one to use when pre-empting another player's debate. Using this will also move the corresponding marker on the *French Debate Pre-emps Used* track on the board.



IMPORTANT: You **MUST** push the debate button to be able to play a card for debate.

Diplomacy phase: End

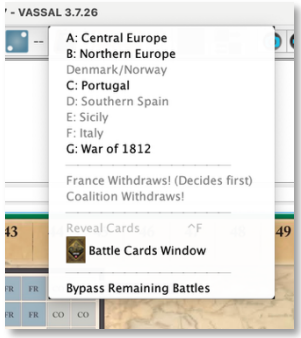
On When the diplomacy phase ends the module will detect the winner of the conference, move the big golden pawn to that power track and automatically award VPs. In case of a tie

that doesn't involve the British, the golden pawn will be placed on the conference table and its context menu can be used by the British to select the conference winner.

Government phase: Issue Resolution

Proceed with this normally. Note that some issues have a context menu with options to aid the resolution, e.g. Sweden at War has an activation option that adds 3 Swedish units to the Northern Front, Military Ops has options to send the op to the Power's capital, and so on. Likewise, the stacks of military units have a context menu that allows them to be sent to various locations on the board.

War phase: Military Operations/Battles



Use the "Fronts" button on the toolbar. When clicked it will display a menu containing all fronts in the game. If a front has a military operations issue on it, it will be highlighted, otherwise greyed out. Select the front you wish to resolve. When selected some of the DRMs involved in that war will be automatically calculated and the pawns on the Battle DRM Track will be updated automatically. The DRMs handled by the module are

- Number of units & fleets
- Military Support markers
- Generalissimo
- Meddling Tsar
- Homeland bonus
- Amphibious assault
- Defender in mountain space
- Guerilla bonus
- Initial Situation Card bonus

TIP: The module is quite verbose about its activities. Check the chat box if you're unsure about which DRMs have been added.

Using Battle Cards

The module offers a way to select battle cards secretly, then displaying them all at the same time. Each power involved in the battle must select the cards they wish to use as battle cards by opening the hand window and clicking on the cards you wish to use. They will be indicated by a thick red border. To unselect a card just click it again. When your selection is complete, click the button with the battle symbol and the letter for the active front in your card window's toolbar. This will open a new window with the played battle cards. **Don't worry if it is empty**, it will not fill until all players have selected their cards and clicked the button. The module will prevent you from selecting cards with no battle instructions and/or cards belonging to another power.

IMPORTANT: All involved powers must click the toolbar button, even if no battle cards were selected.

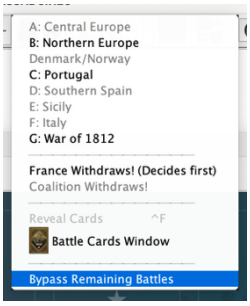
IMPORTANT: The module will not apply any of the battle card instructions, only display the cards.

TIP: The use of the battle window is for convenience only; it is also possible to use other methods. For example, dragging cards face-down to the board

TIP: If you make a mistake, for example, selecting the wrong card you can just drag it back to your hand window.

Resolving Battle Manually

You always have the option to ignore the features of the Fronts button, and its menu, and resolve some, or all, of the battles manually. If you choose to do so, make sure to click the Fronts button and select the menu option "Bypass Remaining Battles" when finished, to notify the module that battle resolution is done.



End phase: Ending the Turn

Click the end-turn button in the toolbar. This will clean up all issues and markers and add them to their respective place on the board, discard all remaining cards and shuffle the deck. In addition, some VP awards are automatically managed by the module. In the game VPs are organized into three different types

VPs awarded each turn

All of these are awarded automatically:

- Control of Castille is awarded automatically
- Control of Prussia is awarded automatically
- Austria at war is awarded automatically
- War of 1812 including Treaty of Gent & Annex of Canada is awarded automatically

VPs awarded once per game

- Amour Sacré del Patrie is awarded automatically (including the die-roll)
- Surrender of Napoleon is not automated and must be awarded manually

VPs awarded at game end

None of these are automated and needs to be awarded manually

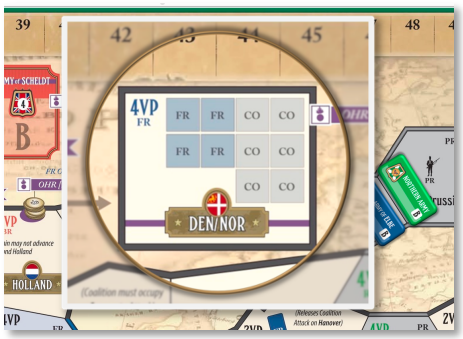
TIP: The module is quite verbose about its activities. Check the chat box if you're unsure about which VPs have been awarded.

IMPORTANT: The module also adjusts hand sizes for the powers.

Other Module Features

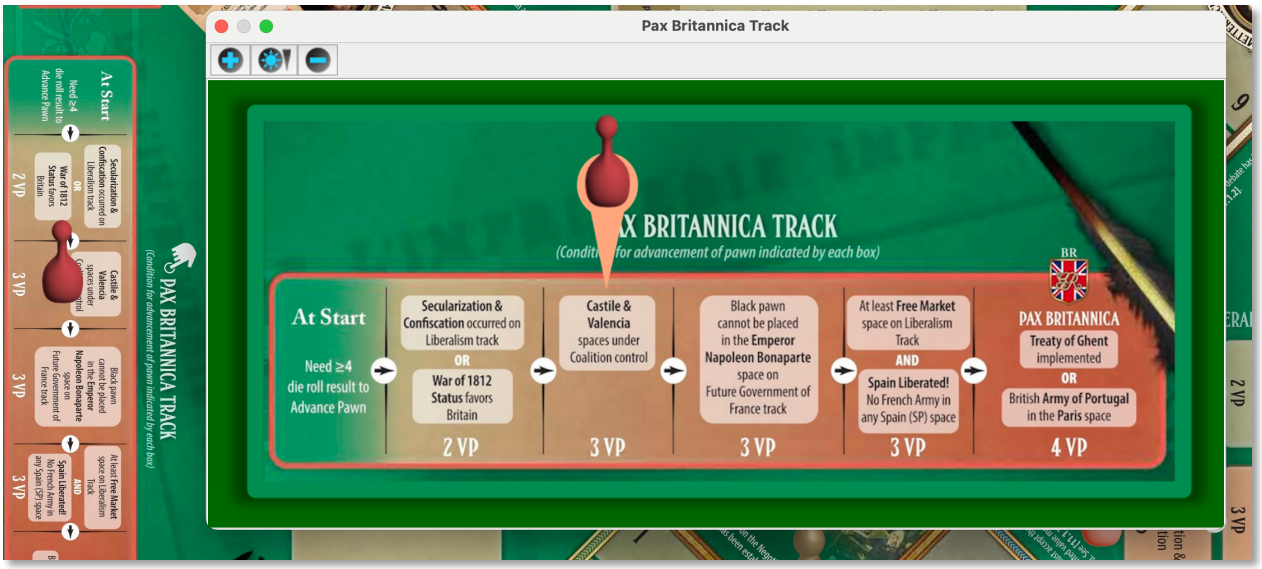
Front track spaces display

If a space on a front is covered by pieces and markers you can get a view of the space by moving your mouse over the name of the space. This will trigger a small popup displaying the space



Track displays

Some tracks on the diplomacy section of the map can be displayed in a pop-up window. To open the pop-up, click the name of the track on the map. To close the window just click anywhere in the pop-up.



Interactive sequence of play